

PRATEEK VERMA

Canadian Citizen

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SUMMARY:

Highly energetic and self-driven Lead Infrastructure Specialist / Cloud Architect with 14 years of experience in designing, operating, provisioning, troubleshooting, administering, and integrating cloud, network, and security infrastructure and IP networks

CERTIFICATIONS:

- AWS certified security - specialty(SCS-CO2)
- Designing and implement Microsoft Azure networking solution (**AZ-700**)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (**CSA**)
- Cisco Certified Network Associate (R&S)
- Cisco Certified Network Professional (R&S)
- Implementing and Operating Data center core technologies (**DCCOR**)
- HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate (003)
- Successfully completed ITIL foundations and Lean Six Sigma Green and Black belt.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES:

- Solid hands-on experience with multicloud platforms (AWS, Azure, GCP), including the F5 Shape Distributed Cloud Bot Defense project by implementing bot protection and perimeter security across managed enterprise infrastructure.
- Expertise in designing, managing, and implementing Cisco ACI multi-site data center migrations and Meraki SD-WAN projects across global data centers, corporate sites, and warehouse infrastructures.
- Deep technical experience with Azure cloud architecture, including VNET, Azure Functions, ExpressRoute, Azure Firewall, Front Door, Load Balancer packet engineering, virtualization, serverless computing, networking, storage, security, and system administration.
- Led the design, implementation, and deployment of an AWS Magento cloud-native project, incorporating AWS CloudFront CDN, Lambda@Edge, Distribution Lists, Route 53, Security Groups, VPC, Transit Gateway, and infrastructure services such as VPCs, VPN, Load Balancers, Route Tables, Subnets, NAT and Internet Gateways, and WAF.
- Expertise in re-platforming and re-architecting cloud infrastructure using AWS and GCP services, including Networking, Windows/Linux virtual machines, EC2, S3, Storage, AWS Direct Connect, API Gateway, GCP Cloud Router, Cloud Interconnect, Cloud Armor, and Cloud DNS.
- Led the design, implementation, and deployment of proposed Azure solutions, covering cloud strategy, stakeholder management, and full-scope solution design including business, application, infrastructure, and commercial aspects.
- Expertise in re-platforming and re-architecting Azure target architectures, including Bill of Materials (BoM) pricing and licensing, architectural diagrams (covering all Azure services), High-Level Designs (HLD), and Low-Level Designs (LLD).
- Functional-level scripting experience in integrating, deploying, and implementing Kubernetes architecture by incorporating microservices in Docker containers, managed via API controllers in a distributed multicloud infrastructure.

- Proficient in Linux administration, including troubleshooting using Linux CLI, SCP, and SSH.
- Solid hands-on administration, troubleshooting, and migration experience with on-premises security services, including Palo Alto firewalls (PA-1420, PA-460, PA-5200) integrated with Panorama for features such as deep packet inspection, stateful firewalls, GlobalProtect, Pulse Secure VPN, IDS/IPS platforms, and management of site-to-site IPsec VPN tunnels across multiple data centers.
- Practical experience with Infrastructure as Code (IaC) by implementing GitHub, AWS CloudFormation, and Terraform, along with scripting in Python and JSON for provisioning and deploying web and mobile applications.

WORK HISTORY:

CapitalOne: April 2024 to Present

Infrastructure Specialist

The project involved implementing F5 Distributed Cloud Bot Protection for Capital One websites, including enterprise, financial, retail, direct banking, and technology applications, to defend against external automated bot attacks. The solution integrated Shape Security's F5 Bot Protection with AWS and GCP cloud instances.

Responsibilities:

- Implemented enterprise application protection from external bot attacks by deploying F5 Distributed Cloud Security mechanisms across a multicloud infrastructure managed by the enterprise.
- Designed, deployed, and managed an AWS CloudFront solution integrated with F5 Shape to optimize content delivery for Capital One websites. Configured and maintained CloudFront edge caching, routing policies, SSL/TLS certificates, and Web Application Firewalls (WAF) alongside Application Load Balancers to enhance performance and security.
- Designed, implemented, and supported Capital One's on-premises data center networks located in Chicago and Ashburn. Recommended and executed configuration changes to maintain AWS Direct Connect and VPN connections, including integration with third-party vendors in a distributed multicloud environment.
- Designed and customized AWS CDN services and request/response handling using Lambda@Edge and Google Cloud Functions. Implemented configurations for Route 53, CloudWatch, VPC, F5 mitigation policies, WAF, Application Load Balancers, Transit Gateway, and VPC peering.
- Collaborated with Web Operations, Security, and DevOps teams to ensure smooth CI/CD integration using GitHub, AWS CloudFormation, Terraform, Python, and JSON scripts for automated deployments.
- Implemented and configured Capital One applications as microservices within Docker containers, orchestrated using Kubernetes API controllers, with infrastructure as code using Terraform and GitHub-based deployment pipelines.
- Supported Capital One presales activities, including architecture design, cost estimation, tool and technology evaluations, creation of sales artifacts, and participation in calls for technology practices and sub-practices.
- Conducted system planning studies, modeling, performance and capacity analysis to estimate costs and implement cost-control mechanisms for Azure-based cloud resources. Integrated and deployed traffic monitoring tools such as AWS CloudWatch and Splunk into the existing multicloud infrastructure to monitor network traffic, manage

request handling, track performance metrics, identify bottlenecks, and mitigate latency issues.

LCBO: Feb 2021 to March 2024

Senior Technical Infrastructure Architect

The Liquor Control Board of Ontario (LCBO) is a government enterprise and a responsible retailer and wholesaler of wine, beer, and spirits in Ontario, with core values of engaging customer service, social responsibility, excellence, and integrity. LCBO operates an on-premises data center as the backbone of its infrastructure, hosting multiple servers and network links locally to manage warehouse, district office, and LCBO store infrastructure. Additionally, it has deployed next-generation applications and services on a hybrid cloud environment to efficiently manage operations and deliver services to its customers

Responsibilities:

- Successfully led a multi-site data center ACI migration project, transitioning all internally hosted applications, services, servers, and network links to a next-generation, cutting-edge multi-site and hybrid cloud distributed infrastructure.
- Extensive experience integrating solutions with Azure cloud environments and connecting to cloud-hosted SaaS applications such as Microsoft 365. Migrated 50+ internal LCBO applications and workloads to Azure using network virtualization and Software-Defined Networking (SDN) technologies.
- Redesigned the network infrastructure for corporate offices, warehouses, stores, and district offices by deploying Meraki SD-WAN with high-speed links, establishing end-to-end connectivity across global multi-site data centers.
- Deployed and redistributed QA, development, and testing environments across distributed hybrid AWS and Azure clouds. Established Direct Connect from the on-premises data center to AWS, and migrated 50+ LCBO applications and services to hybrid Azure and AWS environments. Successfully migrated the Order Management System (OMS) from the legacy IBM data center to the ACI multi-site infrastructure.
- Played a key technical role in presenting High-Level Design (HLD) and Low-Level Design (LLD) documentation for ExtraHop and Qualys deployments at the Global Data Center (GDC), as well as the setup of a PCI-compliant network.
- Proposed and contributed to the implementation of Prisma Access and GlobalProtect VPN solutions, presenting designs and recommendations to LCBO management for final review and execution.
- Strong understanding of process-driven global architecture with hands-on coordination involving ISP vendors for hardware/service procurement, RFQ/RFP execution, license renewals, and timely resolution of Priority 1 (P1) issues.

OMERS: June 2019 to Sep 2020

Network Consultant

OMERS initiated an enterprise data center project to consolidate IT-managed infrastructure entities and deliver a common, efficient, secure, and highly available environment. This initiative aimed to unify existing data centers into a single enterprise-grade data center with shared IT architecture, leveraging advanced and robust technologies such as Cisco ACI (Application Centric Infrastructure), VMware NSX, VCE VxBlock, F5 BIG-IP, and Palo Alto Next-Generation Firewalls

Responsibilities:

- Worked as an Infrastructure Consultant providing infrastructure engineering and managed application support to multiple teams, including DevOps, Platform Services, Software Engineering, and Security.
- Designed, implemented, and executed AWS and Azure services such as Amazon CloudFront, Elastic Load Balancing (ELB), Amazon Route 53, Azure VNet, Network Security Groups, and Azure Firewall for optimal traffic distribution in a hybrid cloud infrastructure.
- Performed advanced routing and switching configurations on Cisco ACI, including L3Out route additions, endpoint group creation for specific sites, and Cisco GLO firewall modifications to enable seamless platform communication.
- Led the design and execution of BIG-IP F5 DMZ load balancer services across global data centers using Virtual Clustered Multiprocessing (CMP) technology.
- Designed and supervised the implementation of FortiGate firewall policies, F5 load balancer configurations, and Cisco ASA VPN setups across globally distributed remote sites.
- Executed DMZ project implementation for vSphere expansion by modifying network configurations on edge switches and Palo Alto PA-5020 firewalls, and enabling IP network accessibility through appropriate route additions on Cisco ACI.
- Managed application deployments while reducing network dependencies by configuring virtual servers, pool members, and nodes on F5 LTM/DNS, and allowing virtual server traffic and backend server ports through next-generation Palo Alto firewalls.
- Researched, developed, and implemented IT standards, best practices, and operational procedures; monitored access privileges, conducted risk assessments, investigated suspicious activities, and remediated identified security threats

Accenture Consulting: July 2014 to January 2019

Senior Network Engineer

Worked on the British Telecom project at Accenture, based on-site at the client location in Ipswich, UK, for two years. Led and managed the data center team and oversaw the enterprise network security project for British Telecom.

Responsibilities:

- Served as Technical Lead in designing and implementing administrative policies for Viptela SD-WAN (Zero Touch Provisioning), including seamless integration with AWS cloud environments (EC2, VPC, S3, EBS, ACLs).
- Deployed and implemented a highly available F5 LTM/DNS infrastructure, administering load balancing standards, documentation, processes, and operational procedures.
- Collected and acted on client and stakeholder requirements to enhance security; administered and maintained high availability clustered firewall environments for BT Headend customers using Palo Alto HA and Nokia VRRP.
- Actively contributed to engineering change plans, service requests, and incident escalations involving a wide array of network devices, including multi-vendor L2/L3 switches, Nexus vPC/OTV, Cisco wireless controllers and APs, F5 LTM/DNS, and Palo Alto appliances within the BT Headend network.
- Delivered Cisco Advanced Services in Routing, Switching, and Security (SD-WAN, MPLS, BGP, EIGRP, HSRP, QoS, IPS, DLP, UTM), covering advisory, implementation, and migration services for large-scale BT Headend and service provider environments.

Cisco Systems: November 2012 to May 2014:

Network Engineer

Deployed to Cisco Systems as a consultant through VARITE Pvt. Ltd., working on the WNBUI Infrastructure Project—one of Cisco's flagship enterprise network initiatives. Collaborated with the Global TAC team and was responsible for executing network change migrations, device upgrades, and providing on-call support for multiple clients across various geographic locations

Responsibilities:

- Implemented and deployed Cisco wireless infrastructure projects across Cisco's global customer networks. Worked closely with the Cisco TAC team to resolve chronic issues related to routing, switching, security, and wireless-managed devices in multi-customer environments.
- Handled numerous issues involving Cisco ISE, wireless packet roaming problems, IPsec VPN tunnel flapping and disconnections, as well as firewall configuration changes for customer environments using Palo Alto Panorama. Successfully resolved issues during live troubleshooting sessions by analyzing traffic hits under monitor sessions and ACC, creating policy-based rules, and deploying NAT policies on Palo Alto firewalls.
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Tata consultancy services: November 2011 to July 2012

Associate Network Engineer

Worked at the Supervalu Global Network Operations Center, providing network infrastructure changes, support, and configuration implementation across the Supervalu customer network. Additionally, delivered 24/5 remote on-call support to Supervalu clients

Responsibilities:

- Provided expert-level network support as part of the global NOC team for Supervalu clients, contributing to the delivery of Data over IP and WAN networks. Delivered support for Palo Alto Firewalls through Panorama, including critical policy changes, traffic flow issues, and remote access VPN problems, while managing NOC operations.
- Troubleshoot, analyzed, and resolved technical queries for Supervalu clients using ServiceNow and JIRA ticketing systems, handling high-severity incidents, major changes, problem management tickets, and root cause analysis (RCA) for F5 LTM, routing, and switching Layer 3 critical issues escalated by multiple teams.

3i-infotech consultancy services: Feb 2009 to September 2010

Network Administrator

I was involved in a network implementation project deployed across multiple remote cities in the Asia Pacific region. The objective was to connect each district (state) to its State Headquarters (SHQ) via a 2 Mbps dedicated leased line. Each SHQ was then connected to the headquarters via a 100 Mbps link from PGCIL, with a backup 100 Mbps link from the main data center.

Responsibilities:

- Troubleshoot packet-level network issues for National Information Center (NIC) clients using Wireshark, tcpdump, Cisco DNA Center, and CA NetFlow Analyzer. Resolved enterprise-level system and network issues, including routing, switching, Palo Alto firewall configurations, F5 GTM/LTM load balancing, stacked switch connectivity, and ISP link failures.
- Utilized HP Network Node Manager i (NNMi) to proactively monitor all enterprise network nodes. Created and managed tickets with ISPs for backbone link flaps and downtime events, ensuring timely resolution and thorough root cause analysis.

EDUCATION AND CREDENTIALS:

Bachelor of Computer Science and Engineering, June 2005 to July 2008 University of Rajiv Gandhi Proudyogiki Vishwavidyalaya (RGPV), Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh"